Elif Sena Akel

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SUMMARY

Computer Science master's student at Old Dominion University with a B.S. in Computer Science from Virginia Tech. Interested in software development and AI, with hands-on experience building web applications, data science projects, and team-based Agile projects.

EDUCATION

Old Dominion University, Norfolk, VA | Jan 2026 - May 2028 (Expected)
M.S., Computer Science

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA | Aug 2023 – Dec 2025
B.S., Computer Science

Old Dominion University, Norfolk, VA | Aug 2021 – Jul 2023
Computer Science coursework (transferred to Virginia Tech)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Old Dominion University | Fall 2026 – Present
Advisor: Dr. Ajay Gupta · Detecting agitation in Alzheimer's patients using wearable sensors, audio and video.

- Developing a pipeline that streams smartwatch sensor data to a real-time laptop dashboard through a background service.
- Building a mobile app for caregivers to log behaviors with the CMAI (Cohen-Mansfield Agitation Inventory) form and track 14-day scores.

PROJECTS

Movie Box Office Revenue Prediction | CS 620 Data Project, Old Dominion University - Fall 2026 (In progress)

- Collecting and cleaning data on American films (2022–2025) from Wikipedia and the TMDB API to predict domestic box office revenue.
- Applying data wrangling, exploratory analysis, visualization, and machine learning models in a Colab notebook.

Hokie TEACH: TA Assignment Web Application | Senior Capstone, Virginia Tech - Fall 2025

- Collaborated in a team of four to extend a web application that matches graduate teaching assistants to CS courses based on skills, course experience, and preferences.
- Worked on semester-based filtering, role-based views for admins, professors, and TAs, CSV data import/export, and the TA evaluation system.
- Presented the project as a poster at the VTURCS Fall 2025 Research Symposium.

Movie Review Platform | Software Engineering Team Project, Virginia Tech - Fall 2024

- Defined the product vision, user stories, and roadmap using Agile Scrum to plan sprints and prioritize features.
- Developed front-end and back-end components for user authentication, movie search, review posting, and bookmarking, with responsive interfaces.

Accessible Engineering Design Project | Engineering Team Project, Virginia Tech - Fall 2023

- Designed and prototyped an accessible doorknob for people with hand disabilities in a multidisciplinary team.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, C++, C
Languages: Turkish (native), English (advanced)

AWARDS

Dean's Perfect Scholar (Fall 2021 – Fall 2022) and Dean's List (Fall 2021 – Spring 2023), Old Dominion University